



*Mahesh Gupta at a Kent RO showroom*

also take care of the undesirable dissolved elements while recognising and retaining the good minerals.”

As a technocrat, Mahesh understood the necessity and market gap for a suitable water purifier, and Kent RO Systems was born from the need to provide clean water to society. He checked the suitability of the available technologies to get the desired result. After several trials and six months of hard work, he zeroed in on reverse osmosis (RO) technology as it helped him achieve the desired results.

The first Kent water purifier was launched in March 1999. Initially, the product was costlier than its competing products because of superior technology and imported components, and the company did not have any marketing budget to promote the product. However, Mahesh was confident about the quality of his invention and value addition. Therefore, rather than making the product cost-competitive, he decided to work on branding, marketing, and after-sales

service-related areas.

Mahesh says, “Gradually, our customers began realising the superiority of our product and our sales started picking up through word-of-mouth publicity by the users. I reinvested the profit in the business and initiated a brand campaign as well as streamlined distribution, sales, and after-sales services.”

Soon after, Mahesh decided to select a suitable brand ambassador to enhance visibility and brand recall. In 2006, Kent RO managed to rope in famous Bollywood actress Hema Malini as its brand ambassador, who was later joined by her daughters Esha and Ahana Deol in the promotional campaigns.

While describing this collaboration with Hema Malini, Mahesh says, “We were in search of a celebrity who is glamorous yet suitable as an experienced homemaker. Therefore, we preferred Hema Malini ji over other younger actresses. I think she is a time-tested face yet extremely glamorous and popular. We were also judicious while selecting

the right media partners, considering our limited budget.”

With innovative marketing strategy and superior product quality, Kent RO has become the largest manufacturer of water purifiers in the country. Today, it is a more than 1000 crore (₹10 billion) company. Mahesh’s leadership plays a critical role in this journey. While leading a team, Mahesh depends on trust. He prefers his team members to deliver work efficiently and in a trustworthy manner within a controlled budget environment.

Mahesh says, “I always try to remain sincere towards my employees and business peers. I think that is why people believe me today. The only thing which makes both personal and professional relationships work is trust. Trust is built by your actions over a long period. If you continue to do it, people will believe you.”

Nurturing life with family, passion, and spirituality, Mahesh began his family life simultaneously with his professional journey. He got married at the age of twenty-six. He considers his wife, Sunita, a pillar of strength in his life and a great support in his entrepreneurial journey.

He mentions, “My wife started as a homemaker, but my father taught her business skills and encouraged her to join my venture. Thus, she became an integral part of my business as well.”

They are blessed with two children—one daughter and one son. His daughter, Surbhi, did her bachelor’s in architecture from the prestigious CEPT, Ahmedabad, and master’s in architecture from Architecture Association, London—one of the most respected institutions for architecture globally. His son, Varun, is a computer engineer from Purdue University, USA, and an MBA from Columbia University, New York—one of the top business schools in the world. He joined the family business in 2005